# ECOTURISMO

Panama

Travis Newton

2026-05-01

GMU SPN110

## OPCIONES

## DONDE

- Coiba National Park / Prison
- Chiriqui Gulf
- South Central Panama
- 25 NM de Santa Catalina
- 38 pequenas isles: 430,825 acres
- Cobia separated de Panama entre hace 12.000 y 18.000 anos

## GENERAL DESCRIPTION

- UNESCO as a Mundo Heritage Site in 2005
- Coiba isle y otras isles son selva tropical (rainforest)
- Wildlife
  - 147 species, 20 endemic ave especia
  - Coiba Spinetail (ave), Coiba Howler mono (monkey)
  - Rare scarlet macaw (toucan sam)
- Terreno (terrian)
  - Center of island muy rugged leading to alta rio drain off of sediments y nutrients into the oceano
  - north end mas visitido
    - blanco sand playas, bucear , esnorquel (snorkel)
  - south side mostly untouched
    - offers good surfing for those that make the trip

## THINGS TO DO

- Senderismo (wildlife o bird watching ecotour)
  - Monkey (1000m)
  - Gambute peak (200m)
  - Hot springs (750m)
- Pesca (inshore o offshore)
  - South side butts up contra the continental shelf grande game pez como el marlin
  - Permit requrido (required)
- Whale watching (Kayak o Snorkeling)
  - Jul - Oct is the Humpback Whale migration season

## HISTORIA

- Penal colony from 1919 – 2004
  - **Buffer was created around colony**, 80% of preserve untouched by humans
  - 3000 inmates (hard criminals and political prisoner)
  - 30 camps scattered and isolated from uno another
  - die in the camp, unmarked grave o dismembered y fed to sharks
  - Escape impossible...dense jungle, sharks and crocodiles

## ECONOMIA HOY

- Park is accessible only by permit from ANAM to the tourist companies.
  - Empezar en $60-$700 for activitdo (alto groupo activido)
  - te tambien neccesito visitante pass no includio por $20
- Santa catalina is departure location for Corbia
  - David - 4hrs por $35
  - PTY - 5hr por $60
- Lodging
  - Few 2 rooms cabins at ranger station
  - Hostels / Hotels in Santa Catalina $30 - $150

## MEDIOAMBIENTE IMPACTO

- Otras
  - Removal of fishing nets and equipment de los sitios de buceo (dive sites)
- Funds
  - Investigacion station and improvements
  - Low impact trails (forest) and catwalks (at prison structure)
  - Park ranger casas
  - Future: ecotourism fully sustainable guest casas
- Avance Medico
  - forty five nuevo chemicals were extracted from coral, sponges, fungi, and bacteria that showed a great promise to cure cancer and other tropical diseases.

## LAST FACT

- It is now said that the prison is **haunted** by the ghosts of prisoners.
  - One story is that a guard was chasing a prisoner, but the prisoner was a ghost. The guard was so scared that he shot himself.

## REFERENCES


- ABC News : 'Last Lands' travels to former Panama island prison that became national park
  https://abcnews.com/International/lands-travels-former-panama-island-prison-national-park/story?id=12677381
- Strategy for a Protected Paradise: Coiba National Park
  https://diazdiaz.com/article/strategy-paradise-coiba-national-park
- Coiba National Park Tours
  https://www.coibanationalpark.com